Week 7 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, October 21 – 24, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 7

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (17–20), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: Has anybody seen my Mopser? —

Recitation: Genesis 1:1 ESV — from your physical Bible; wording not printed here. Optional: say last week's "The Huntsmen" by heart.

Hymn: first stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (start a second only if the first is solid)

Folk song: "The Bold Grenadier"

Math: Ray's Lessons 17–20. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 21	Exodus 17 + Awana	Our Island Story ch. 27, William the Red	Ray's L17 · copywork · hymn · "The Bandog"
Thu 22	short / hymn + Awana	Little Duke, ch. 4 first half	Harvey's · Tree in the Trail ch. 5 · folk
Fri 23	hymn (lighter Bible)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 7	Grimm · CHOW Real Castles · Shakespeare · picture study
Sat 24	Luke 20:27–47	Understood Betsy ch. 6	Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress · evening walk

Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy — passages by reference only; no verse text printed)
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 17–20
- Harvey's Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two short sittings
- *Our Island Story*, ch. 27 (printed)
- *The Little Duke*, ch. 4 first half (printed)
- *Tree in the Trail* — ch. 5 from **your copy** (not printed; still catching up — do **not** jump to AO ch. 10)
- Hillyer *A Child's History of the World* — "Real Castles" from **your copy** (not printed)
- Grimm's Pantheon — one gentle tale by title (not printed)
- *Burgess Animal Book*, ch. 7 (ch. 8 printed, optional) · *Understood Betsy*, ch. 6

Two children

Astoria does the whole morning. Tracy joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, Grimm, and outside — see the Preschool corner page. During math, copywork, and heavier history she plays nearby with McGuffey pictures.

Weather

Bastrop late October: cooler mornings, still warm by noon. Outside early or after 5pm. Times slide; keep the order.

This week's shifts

Island Story ch. 27 (William the Red). **CHOW returns** — "Real Castles" from your Hillyer. Geography stays *Tree in the Trail* catch-up ch. 5 (not AO's ch. 10). Burgess ch. 7 (ch. 8 optional). No Trial and Triumph ~~(Anselm ~Week 9). No Cooper chapter. No Parables~~ from Nature.

Free sources

Books on the shelf (and what waits)

What the house owns, what is assigned this week, and what waits. Copyrighted books are never reprinted.

YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

Tree in the Trail (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 5 (~15–20 min, Thursday). Weeks 3–6 were ch. 1–4. Do **not** jump to AO Week 7's TITT ch. 10. Never reprint.

Hillyer, A Child's History of the World — "Real Castles" (ch. 50 in modern editions / ch. 48 in the 1st ed). From **your copy**, Friday. Never reprint.

Trial and Triumph (Hannula) — not assigned this week. Alfred was Week 5. Next is Anselm, around Week 9. Shelf only. Never reprint.

Seabird (Holling) — owned. Hold until AO around Week 19. Shelf only until then.

SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · INSIDE THE SAME MORNING

- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 17–20; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat), next lesson from your place.
- **Grimm's Pantheon** — one short gentle tale by title (suggested: "The Elves and the Shoemaker"). Open your Pantheon. Never reprint.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's informal picture-page while Astoria does copywork or math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in the physical book. Never reprint.

BUY-AHEAD / LATER THIS YEAR

Nothing to buy for Weeks 7–9. Everything AO schedules in those weeks is either public domain (printed in the packets) or already on your shelf (Hillyer, *Trial and Triumph*, *Tree in the Trail*). Diane Stanley's *Joan of Arc* is still about Weeks 22–25 away, too early to buy. The library is fine for picture study or composer listening.

No Cooper chapter this week. Charlotte Mason reminders are on the next page instead.

How to sit with them this week

Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.

01 Narration is the lesson

Read once. Close the book. Let Astoria tell it back. Do not interrupt or prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank her. Do not grade it.

02 Short lessons

Fifteen to twenty minutes. Stop while she still wants more. Ray’s is one lesson. Island Story is one chapter. Do not put history and Little Duke in the same hour.

03 One reading

Read it carefully once. If you re-read “to make sure she got it,” she learns she doesn’t have to listen the first time. Trust the narration.

04 Wait

After you close the book, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. Silence is not failure. It is the mind at work.

05 Atmosphere

The room teaches. Calm voice, tidy table, no rushing or shaming. If the morning falls apart, a song and a walk still count as school. Pick up tomorrow.

06 Two children

Tracy joins the stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, and nature. She is not expected to narrate. Quiet play or McGuffey pictures during math and copywork.

07 Keep the shelf books light

Ray’s, Harvey’s, Awana, Grimm, TITT, and CHOW fit into the same morning, not a second school day. Awana only Wed and Thu, after Bible.

08 Habit of attention

Mid-term is when attention drifts. Keep lessons short rather than longer. A finished short lesson builds the habit; a dragged-out one wears it down.

How to teach this week

Island Story ch. 27. Little Duke opens ch. 4. CHOW Real Castles from your copy. Exodus 17. No Trial and Triumph.

01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 17 (water from the rock; Amalek). It can run long — read once and narrate the main thread; Thursday may finish any leftover verses, or keep OT Wed-only as in Week 6. Saturday: Luke 20:27–47 (Sadducees' question; warning about the scribes). Friday: lighter Bible — hymn first. Open your ESV; never print verse text.

02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible. Next page in their physical Awana book. Never reprint Awana. No Awana Fri or Sat.

03 Ray's Lessons 17–20

Continue after Week 6's Lessons 13–16. One lesson each school day. Oral first when the book allows. Do not dump pages. Tracy plays nearby with McGuffey pictures.

04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "The Bandog": *Has anybody seen my Mopser?* — Best handwriting, then stop. Recitation stays Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (reference only here). Optional: have her say "The Huntsmen" by heart, since she copied it last week.

05 Island Story ch. 27 · William the Red

Printed in full. One sitting Wednesday. Narrate how Rufus took the crown, how he broke his promises, and how he died in the New Forest. **Intensity note:** the hunting death and the cart are sad but not graphic; read ahead if you want to soften a line.

06 CHOW · Real Castles (from your copy)

Friday, from your Hillyer. Modern editions call it ch. 50; the 1st ed is around ch. 48. Open the book; never reprint. Keep it to ~15–20 min. Do not pair with Island Story the same day.

07 Little Duke, ch. 4 first half

Richard meets Alberic de Montemar; the boys become playfellows; Alberic stays at Rouen. Printed. Cap ~20 min. Stop before winter and the King's arrival (second half next week). Narrate who Alberic is and why Richard wanted him to stay.

08 Tree in the Trail, ch. 5

From **your copy**. One sitting Thursday, ~15–20 min. Still catching up (Weeks 3–6 were ch. 1–4). Do **not** jump to AO's ch. 10. Never reprint TITT.

09 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu and Sat), the next lesson from where you stopped. Oral and light. Do not dump the book.

10 Grimm by title only

Open your Pantheon. One short gentle tale — suggested: "The Elves and the Shoemaker." (Sweet Porridge or The Golden Goose are fine alternates if you already used Elves.) Avoid a gruesome tale. Never reprint.

11 Burgess, one chapter (two if it goes well)

Ch. 7, "Johnny Chuck Joins the Class," is the week's chapter (Week 6 printed it as optional — if you already read it, treat this as review or move to ch. 8). Ch. 8, "Whistler and Yap Yap," is printed as an optional second sitting. Do not jump to AO's ch. 9 yet.

12 What you are not doing

No Cooper chapter. No Trial and Triumph. No Seabird until ~Week 19. No Parables from Nature. No jumping ahead in Tree in the Trail to AO ch. 10. No Wind in the Willows (finished).

How to teach this week

Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, Shakespeare, poetry, late-October riches.

13 Understood Betsy ch. 6

"If You Don't Like Conversation in a Book Skip This Chapter!" Betsy and the Putney cousins talk. It's a long chapter (printed in full), so stop at 20 minutes. Finish later the same day or at bedtime. Narrate one thing that surprised Betsy about farm talk.

14 Pilgrim's Progress, Evangelist

Continues right where Week 6 stopped. Evangelist finds Christian under the hill, questions him about Worldly Wiseman, and begins to show him why that counsel was deadly. About 1,100 words printed. Stop at Evangelist's third point; Christian asks to go back to the wicket-gate next week.

15 Shakespeare · Romeo and Juliet (Nesbit)

E. Nesbit's gentle retelling, one sitting through the secret marriage (~15–20 min). Printed. Stop before Tybalt. Both children may listen; narrate who loved whom and why it was secret.

16 Poetry: "The Bandog"

Walter de la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. A comic missing-dog poem after "The Huntsmen." Read it once; both children will enjoy Mopser. Copywork comes from the opening.

17 Dictation (optional, Saturday)

If copywork is going well: have her look at *Has anybody seen my Mopser?* — until she can see it with her eyes shut, then write it as you say it once. Five minutes. Skip it if she's tired.

18 Term 1 riches

Hymn: first stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (start the second only if the first is solid). Folk: "The Bold Grenadier," clean verses. Picture study: continue Rockwell *Freedom of Worship*, or move to the next Freedom if last week's look felt finished — look, turn it over, and have her describe it. Composer: Bernstein, *Jeremiah*; five to eight minutes. Nothing copyrighted is printed.

19 Nature

Lost Pines sit or porch sit most mornings. Saturday evening walk if the weather allows. Nature notebook: one drawing, date it, scribe one sentence she says.

20 Preschool corner

Tracy's informal page is in this packet. Same spirit as Week 6: join stories and songs; McGuffey pictures nearby; no worksheets.

21 Intensity / preview

Island Story's forest death is sad. Romeo sitting stops before the duel and the tomb. PP has Evangelist's severe counsel — read it calmly; Form IB can take Bunyan's tone for one sitting.

Tracy’s week

She joins what fits. She is not expected to narrate, copy, or sit through math.

01 Join freely

Nature sits and walks, Bible (as long as she’ll sit), the hymn and “The Bold Grenadier,” “The Bandog,” Burgess woodchucks and marmots, the Grimm tale, picture study, and the Nesbit Romeo sitting if she stays.

02 Nearby during hard work

McGuffey Pictorial Primer picture-pages, a busy-hands basket, or quiet play while Astoria does Ray’s, copywork, Island Story, Little Duke, or Harvey’s.

03 “The Bandog” game

After the poem: pretend to call “Mopser!” around the room once. Then stop. No worksheet.

04 Awana days

She may listen near Bible and Awana on Wed and Thu, or play in the same room. She does not do the workbook.

05 Outside is her classroom

Cooler October mornings: pine cones, leaf colors, birds at the feeder. Name one thing each day.

06 What Tracy is not doing

No worksheets, no recitation, no scoring. If she’s fussy, the mornings take the order of the day and nothing more.

07 Castles and knights

If she overhears CHOW “Real Castles” or Island Story, a block tower or a cardboard “castle” afterward is enough. No quiz.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 17) · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 27 (printed) · "The Bandog" · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Backyard or porch, twenty minutes. Pick one thing: a leaf color, a bird, a pine cone. Look at it. Sketch if they want.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 17**

Open your ESV to Exodus 17. Water from the rock; Amalek. Read once, close the Bible, narrate the main thread, then stop. If it runs long, finish leftover verses Thursday.

8:40 **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in the physical Awana book. Never reprint.

8:55 **Hymn** TRACY JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today." Sing it; don't explain it to death.

9:05 **Ray's · Lesson 17**

Next lesson after Week 6's Lesson 16. Oral first. One lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-page or busy-hands basket.

9:25 **Copywork + recitation**

Copywork: *Has anybody seen my Mopser?* — Recitation: Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (wording not printed).

9:40 **History · Island Story ch. 27**

"The Story of William the Red." Printed. Cap ~20 min. Narrate. **Stop.** CHOW is Friday, not today.

10:10 **Poem · "The Bandog"** TRACY JOINS

Read once. Both children. No talk afterward unless they start it.

How to teach Wednesday

> **Island Story ch. 27.** Printed in full. No CHOW today — save Real Castles for Friday. No Trial and Triumph this week.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 17 is enough for Wednesday. Water from the rock, then Amalek. One reading; get a clear narration. Awana after Bible, physical book only, then put it away. Leftover verses may finish Thursday if needed.

Ray’s Lesson 17

Pick up the Mott Ray’s where Week 6 stopped. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if she’s eager.

Island Story

William Rufus takes the crown, wins English help against the Norman nobles, then breaks his promises. He dies in the New Forest — some say Walter Tyrrell’s arrow. Let her tell it in her own order. A timeline mark for 1087–1100 is a nice extra.

Poem

“The Bandog” is this week’s poem and where the copywork comes from. Read it for fun.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she’ll sit, hymn, poem. McGuffey or the busy-hands basket during Ray’s and copywork. She can listen to Island Story if she’s still; she doesn’t narrate.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Bible · Exodus 17

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 17.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Water from the rock; Amalek. If long, finish leftover verses Thursday.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Our Island Story · Chapter 27 · The Story of William the Red

H. E. Marshall, Our Island Story. Public-domain text (Heritage History / 1905 Jack edition). Full chapter.

CHAPTER XXVII · THE STORY OF WILLIAM THE RED

William Rufus, or the Red as he was called, from the colour of his hair, took the ring from his father's hand and hurried off to seize the throne of England, without waiting even till the Conqueror should die. In little more than a fortnight the crown was upon the head of William Rufus, and England had another Norman king.

But even the Norman nobles were not pleased with their new king. The Conqueror had ruled them with an iron hand, and they had hoped, when he was dead, to have some one who would be less severe. They wanted Robert, the eldest son of William the Conqueror, because they knew that he was much less harsh than William, and they thought that they would be able to do what they liked if Robert were king. So they rebelled against William the Red and asked Robert to come to England to fight for the crown.

Now the English hated to have a Norman king, but they hated the Norman nobles even more. Although William the Red was Norman he had lived in England ever since he had been about six years old. He could speak English, which the Conqueror could never learn to do, and which the Confessor had never cared to do.

So William the Red appealed to the English people. He said to them, 'If you stand by me and fight for me, I will reward you. I will take away some of the heavy taxes, I will give you more liberty, and I will not allow the Norman barons to oppress you.'

So the English people fought for their Norman king, and they beat the Norman nobles. Robert was obliged to fly back to France, and William the Red, with the help of the English people, sat safely on the English throne.

But as soon as he was safe, William forgot about his promises. He oppressed the people as much as ever, and they were almost more unhappy than they had been in the time of his father.

The Red King was wicked and greedy. He stole money from every one, even from the churches, and spent it on his own pleasure. Little good can be said of him except that he was fearless. Still when he was ill, and thought he might die, he became frightened because of the wicked things he had done, and promised to do better. But as soon as he was well again he forgot his fears and was as wicked as before. He was not truly a brave man, and he was very cruel.

One day William the Red went to hunt with his friends in the New Forest—that forest which his father had made by destroying so many villages. Before the hunting-party started, a man came to the King and gave him six beautiful new arrows. The King admired them very much and he gave one of them to his friend, Walter Tyrrell, who was a very good shot, saying, 'The best arrows should be given to him who knows best how to use them.'

It was a gay scene. The King in his rich hunting-dress rode first. His friends and servants, gayly dressed, followed. There was much talking and laughing and barking of dogs.

As they rode into the forest, the frightened deer fled before them, and soon every one was eagerly following the chase. In the many paths of the forest, the King became separated from his friends. The nobles did not notice that the King was not among them, for it often happened in hunting that a few would be separated from the others. When the hunt was over, one by one the hunting-party returned to the palace. Only the King did not return—the King and one noble, Walter Tyrrell.

As the shadows began to lengthen and the sun to set, the people of his household became uneasy. Who was with the King? Who saw him last?

As the question was asked, a peasant's cart came slowly up the street. It was a rough wooden cart drawn by an old white horse, led by a peasant in poor and shabby clothes.

The question was answered. In the cart the King, who so short a time before had ridden gayly away, lay dead, with an arrow through his heart.

'Who has done this?' asked the barons, seizing the peasant. 'Villain, answer.'

'I know naught of it, my lords,' replied the man. 'I was passing through the forest on my way home when I found this man lying dead as you see him. I bethought me that it was the King, so I brought him thither.'

How William the Red was killed can never be known. Some people say that Walter Tyrrell, while aiming at a deer, hit the king by mistake, that the arrow struck a tree and, glancing off, pierced the king in the breast and killed him. These people think that Walter Tyrrell frightened at what he had done, fled away as fast as he could; that he fled to the seashore, got into a ship and sailed over to France.

Certain it is that Walter Tyrrell did run away that day, and did not return to England for many years. But when he came back, he vowed very solemnly that he had not done the deed and that he had not even been near the King that day when he died.

There was no sorrow for the dead king. He was hated so much that, when he was buried, no bell was rung, no prayers were said, and when some time after the tower of the church fell, people said it was because of the wickedness of William, the Red King, who lay buried there.

> **Stop here.** End of chapter. Next Island Story sitting follows AO’s sequence in a later week.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

The Bandog

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie. Project Gutenberg eBook #3753. Public domain. This week's copywork comes from here.

Has anybody seen my Mopser? —
A comely dog is he,
With hair of the colour of a Charles the Fifth,
And teeth like ships at sea,
His tail it curls straight upwards,
His ears stand two abreast,
And he answers to the simple name of Mopser
When civilly addressed.

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible (optional short / leftover Ex 17) · Awana · folk song · Ray's (Lesson 18) · *The Little Duke* ch. 4 first half · Harvey's · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 5) · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes outside or on the porch. Same habit as Wednesday.

8:25 — **Bible · short, or finish Exodus 17**

If Wednesday left verses, finish them. Otherwise a short hymn-led opening and go on — OT may stay Wed-only like Week 6. Open your ESV; no printed text.

8:35 — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Physical workbook only. Never reprint. Last Awana day this week.

8:50 — **Folk song** TRACY JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier," clean verses.

9:00 — **Ray's · Lesson 18**

One lesson. Oral first. Tracy nearby with McGuffey.

9:20 — **Harvey's · short sitting**

~10 minutes from your place in the Mott reprint. Oral and light.

9:30 — **Tales · Little Duke ch. 4 first half**

Alberic de Montemar. Printed. Cap ~20 min. Stop before the King arrives (second half next week).

10:00 — **Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 5**

From **your copy**. Catch-up. Do **not** jump to AO ch. 10. Never reprint.

How to teach Thursday

> **Little Duke opens chapter 4.** TITT ch. 5 from your shelf — still catching up. Harvey's first of two sittings.

Bible and Awana

Only finish Exodus 17 if Wednesday ran short. Otherwise keep Thursday light on OT and protect Little Duke + TITT. Awana after Bible, then put the workbook away until next Wednesday.

Little Duke

Richard wants a playfellow; Alberic comes from the marches of the Epte; the boys spar over status and settle into friendship. Stop when Alberic is staying and the early games are underway — before winter and King Louis.

Tree in the Trail

Chapter 5 from your Holling. Still sequential catch-up after ch. 1–4. AO's Week 7 jumps ahead to ch. 10 — ignore that for now. Never reprint.

Harvey's

Ten minutes. Next lesson from where you stopped. Do not dump the book.

Tracy: nature, folk song, maybe Little Duke listening. McGuffey during Ray's and Harvey's.

READ THIS · THURSDAY (OPTIONAL)

Bible · finish Exodus 17 if needed

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV only if Wednesday left verses unread.

Otherwise skip a second OT sitting and go on to Awana and the day’s readings.

Do not print or paste ESV text — use the physical book only.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

The Little Duke · Chapter 4 · first half

Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke. Project Gutenberg eBook #3048 (Macmillan 1905). Public domain. Stops before King Louis arrives.

CHAPTER IV · FIRST HALF

CHAPTER IV

Richard of Normandy was very anxious to know more of the little boy whom he had seen among his vassals.

"Ah! the young Baron de Montemar," said Sir Eric. "I knew his father well, and a brave man he was, though not of northern blood. He was warden of the marches of the Epte, and was killed by your father's side in the inroad of the Viscount du Cotentin, {10} at the time when you were born, Lord Richard."

"But where does he live? Shall I not see him again?"

"Montemar is on the bank of the Epte, in the domain that the French wrongfully claim from us. He lives there with his mother, and if he be not yet returned, you shall see him presently. Osmond, go you and seek out the lodgings of the young Montemar, and tell him the Duke would see him."

Richard had never had a playfellow of his own age, and his eagerness to see Alberic de Montemar was great. He watched from the window, and at length beheld Osmond entering the court with a boy of ten years old by his side, and an old grey-headed Squire, with a golden chain to mark him as a Seneschal or Steward of the Castle, walking behind.

Richard ran to the door to meet them, holding out his hand eagerly. Alberic uncovered his bright dark hair, bowed low and gracefully, but stood as if he did not exactly know what to do next. Richard grew shy at the same moment, and the two boys stood looking at each other somewhat awkwardly. It was easy to see that they were of different races, so unlike were the blue eyes, flaxen hair, and fair face of the young Duke, to the black flashing eyes and olive cheek of his French vassal, who, though two years older, was scarcely above him in height; and his slight figure, well-proportioned, active and agile as it was, did not give the same promise of strength as the round limbs and large-boned frame of Richard, which even now seemed likely to rival the gigantic stature of his grandfather, Earl Rollo, the Ganger.

For some minutes the little Duke and the young Baron stood surveying each other without a word, and old Sir Eric did not improve matters by saying, "Well, Lord Duke, here he is. Have you no better greeting for him?"

"The children are shame-faced," said Fru Astrida, seeing how they both coloured. "Is your Lady mother in good health, my young sir?"

Alberic blushed more deeply, bowed to the old northern lady, and answered fast and low in French, "I cannot speak the Norman tongue."

Richard, glad to say something, interpreted Fru Astrida's speech, and Alberic readily made courteous reply that his mother was well, and he thanked the Dame de Centeville, a French title which sounded new to Fru Astrida's ears. Then came the embarrassment again, and Fru Astrida at last said, "Take him out, Lord Richard; take him to see the horses in the stables, or the hounds, or what not."

Richard was not sorry to obey, so out they went into the court of Rollo's tower, and in the open air the shyness went off. Richard showed his own pony, and Alberic asked if he could leap into the saddle without putting his foot in the stirrup. No, Richard could not; indeed, even Osmond had never seen it done, for the feats of French chivalry had scarcely yet spread into Normandy.

"Can you?" said Richard; "will you show us?"

"I know I can with my own pony," said Alberic, "for Bertrand will not let me mount in any other way; but I will try with yours, if you desire it, my Lord."

So the pony was led out. Alberic laid one hand on its mane, and vaulted on its back in a moment. Both Osmond and Richard broke out loudly into admiration. "Oh, this is nothing!" said Alberic. "Bertrand says it is nothing. Before he grew old and stiff he could spring into the saddle in this manner fully armed. I ought to do this much better."

Richard begged to be shown how to perform the exploit, and Alberic repeated it; then Richard wanted to try, but the pony's patience would not endure any longer, and Alberic said he had learnt on a block of wood, and practised on the great wolf-hound. They wandered about a little longer in the court, and then climbed up the spiral stone stairs to the battlements at the top of the tower, where they looked at the house-tops of Rouen close beneath, and the river Seine, broadening and glittering on one side in its course to the sea, and on the other narrowing to a blue ribbon, winding through the green expanse of fertile Normandy. They threw the pebbles and bits of mortar down that they might hear them fall, and tried which could stand nearest to the edge of the battlement without being giddy. Richard was pleased to find that he could go the nearest, and began to tell some of Fru Astrida's stories about the precipices of Norway, among which when she was a young girl she used to climb about and tend the cattle in the long light summer time. When the two boys came down again into the hall to dinner, they felt as if they had known each other all their lives. The dinner was laid out in full state, and Richard had, as before, to sit in the great throne-like chair with the old Count of Harcourt on one side, but, to his comfort, Fru Astrida was on the other.

After the dinner, Alberic de Montemar rose to take his leave, as he was to ride half way to his home that afternoon. Count Bernard, who all dinner time had been watching him intently from under his shaggy eye-brows, at this moment turned to Richard, whom he hardly ever addressed, and said to him, "Hark ye, my Lord, what should you say to have him yonder for a comrade?"

"To stay with me?" cried Richard, eagerly. "Oh, thanks, Sir Count; and may he stay?"

"You are Lord here."

"Oh, Alberic!" cried Richard, jumping out of his chair of state, and running up to him, "will you not stay with me, and be my brother and comrade?"

Alberic looked down hesitating.

"Oh, say that you will! I will give you horses, and hawks, and hounds, and I will love you--almost as well as Osmond. Oh, stay with me, Alberic."

"I must obey you, my Lord," said Alberic, "but--"

"Come, young Frenchman, out with it," said Bernard,--"no buts! Speak honestly, and at once, like a Norman, if you can."

This rough speech seemed to restore the little Baron's self-possession, and he looked up bright and bold at the rugged face of the old Dane, while he said, "I had rather not stay here."

"Ha! not do service to your Lord?"

"I would serve him with all my heart, but I do not want to stay here. I love the Castle of Montemar better, and my mother has no one but me."

"Brave and true, Sir Frenchman," said the old Count, laying his great hand on Alberic's head, and looking better pleased than Richard thought his grim features could have appeared. Then turning to Bertrand, Alberic's Seneschal, he said, "Bear the Count de Harcourt's greetings to the noble Dame de Montemar, and say to her that her son is of a free bold spirit, and if she would have him bred up with my Lord Duke, as his comrade and brother in arms, he will find a ready welcome."

"So, Alberic, you will come back, perhaps?" said Richard.

"That must be as my mother pleases," answered Alberic bluntly, and with all due civilities he and his Seneschal departed.

Four or five times a day did Richard ask Osmond and Fru Astrida if they thought Alberic would return, and it was a great satisfaction to him to find that every one agreed that it would be very foolish in the Dame de Montemar to refuse so good an offer, only Fru Astrida could not quite believe she would part with her son. Still no Baron de Montemar arrived, and the little Duke was beginning to think less about his hopes, when one evening, as he was returning from a ride with Sir Eric and Osmond, he saw four horsemen coming towards them, and a little boy in front.

"It is Alberic himself, I am sure of it!" he exclaimed, and so it proved; and while the Seneschal delivered his Lady's message to Sir Eric, Richard rode up and greeted the welcome guest.

"Oh, I am very glad your mother has sent you!"

"She said she was not fit to bring up a young warrior of the marches," said Alberic.

"Were you very sorry to come?"

"I dare say I shall not mind it soon; and Bertrand is to come and fetch me home to visit her every three months, if you will let me go, my Lord."

Richard was extremely delighted, and thought he could never do enough to make Rouen pleasant to Alberic, who after the first day or two cheered up, missed his mother less, managed to talk something between French and Norman to Sir Eric and Fru Astrida, and became a very animated companion and friend. In one respect Alberic was a better playfellow for the Duke than Osmond de Centeville, for Osmond, playing as a grown up man, not for his own amusement, but the child's, had left all the advantages of the game to Richard, who was growing not a little inclined to domineer. This Alberic did not like, unless, as he said, "it was to be always Lord and vassal, and then he did not care for the game," and he played with so little animation that Richard grew vexed.

> **Stop here.** Second half of chapter 4 (winter, King Louis) opens next week.

READ THIS · THURSDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Tree in the Trail · Chapter 5

Holling C. Holling — owned copy · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Tree in the Trail to chapter 5.

Read once from your copy (~15–20 min). Close the book. Narrate. Then stop.

Still catching up: Weeks 3–6 were chapters 1–4. Do **not** jump to AO Week 7's chapter 10.

READ THIS · THURSDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. One short lesson. Stop.

Second Harvey’s sitting is Saturday. Do not dump the book.

Friday

HAVE READY

Hymn · Ray's (Lesson 19) · Burgess ch. 7 (printed) · Grimm Pantheon · picture study · Hillyer CHOW "Real Castles" (your copy) · Nesbit Romeo sitting (printed) · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Look at one thing.

8:25 **Hymn · lighter Bible day**

No third Exodus chapter. Start with "I Bind Unto Myself Today." (Luke is Saturday.) No Awana today.

8:35 **Ray's · Lesson 19**

One lesson. Oral first. Tracy: McGuffey nearby.

8:55 **Nature lore · Burgess ch. 7** TRACY JOINS

"Johnny Chuck Joins the Class." Printed. Cap ~20 min. Narrate. Ch. 8 is optional afterward.

9:20 **Grimm · by title** TRACY JOINS

Open your Pantheon. Suggested: "The Elves and the Shoemaker." Never reprint.

9:35 **Picture study** TRACY JOINS

Rockwell *Freedom of Worship* (continue) or the next Freedom. Look, turn it over, describe.

9:45 **World history · CHOW Real Castles**

From **your Hillyer** (ch. 50 modern / ch. 48 1st ed). Never reprint. Cap ~15–20 min.

10:05 **Shakespeare · Romeo sitting** TRACY MAY LISTEN

Nesbit retelling through the secret marriage. Printed. Stop before Tybalt.

How to teach Friday

> **No Awana. Lighter Bible.** Protect the Burgess narration. CHOW from your shelf. Shakespeare sitting is capped.

Burgess

Ch. 7 is the week's chapter. If you already read it as Week 6's optional sitting, treat today as a short review narration or go straight to optional ch. 8. Do not jump to AO's ch. 9.

Grimm

"The Elves and the Shoemaker" (or Sweet Porridge / The Golden Goose if Elves is used up). One tale. Close the book. Let her tell it.

CHOW

"Real Castles" from your Hillyer only. Keep it short. Do not reprint. Not the same day as Island Story (that was Wednesday).

Romeo and Juliet (Nesbit)

Gentle sitting through the Capulet feast, the balcony, and the secret marriage at Friar Laurence's cell. Stop before "a dreadful thing happened." Narrate who loved whom and why it was secret. The duel and the tomb wait for another week.

Picture study

Continue Freedom of Worship, or advance to the next Freedom if last week felt finished. Five minutes is enough.

Tracy: nature, hymn, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, and Romeo if she stays. McGuffey during Ray's.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 7 · Johnny Chuck Joins the Class

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children. Project Gutenberg eBook #2441. Public domain. Full chapter.

CHAPTER VII JOHNNY CHUCK JOINS THE CLASS

Peter Rabbit delivered Mother Nature's message to Johnny Chuck. Johnny didn't seem at all pleased. He grumbled and growled to himself. He didn't want to go to school. He didn't want to learn anything about his relatives. He was perfectly satisfied with things as they were. The truth is, Johnny Chuck was already beginning to get fat with good living and he is naturally lazy. As a rule he can find plenty to eat very near his home, so he seldom goes far from his own doorstep. Peter left him grumbling and growling, and chuckled to himself all the way back to the dear Old Briar-patch. He knew that Johnny Chuck would not dare disobey Old Mother Nature.

Sure enough, the next morning Johnny Chuck came waddling through the Green Forest just as Old Mother Nature was about to open school. He didn't look at all happy, and he didn't reply at all to the greetings of the others. But when Old Mother Nature spoke to him he was very polite.

“Good morning, Johnny Chuck,” said she.

Johnny bobbed his head and said, “Good morning.”

“I understand,” continued Old Mother Nature, “That you are not at all interested in learning about your relatives. I am sorry for any one who doesn't want to learn. The more one knows the better fitted he is to take care of himself and do his part in the work of the Great World. However, it wasn't for your benefit that I sent word for you to be here this morning. It was for the benefit of your friends and neighbors. Now sit up so that all can get a good look at you.”

Johnny Chuck obediently sat up, and of course all the others stared at him. It made him feel quite uncomfortable. “You remember,” said Old Mother Nature, “how surprised you little folks were when I told you that Johnny Chuck is a member of the Squirrel family. Happy Jack, you go sit beside Johnny Chuck, and the rest of you look hard at Happy Jack and Johnny and see if you do not see a family resemblance.”

Seeing Happy Jack and Johnny Chuck sitting up side by side, Peter Rabbit caught the resemblance at once. There was sort of family look about them. “Why! Why-ee! Johnny Chuck does look like a Squirrel,” he exclaimed.

“Of course he looks like a Squirrel, because he is one,” said Old Mother Nature. “Johnny Chuck is very much bigger and so stout in the body that he has none of the gracefulness of the true Squirrels. But you will notice that the shape of his head is much the same as that of Happy Jack. He has a Squirrel face when you come to look at him closely. The Woodchucks, sometimes called Ground Hogs, though why any one should call them this is more than I can understand, belong to the Marmot branch of the Squirrel family, and wherever found they look much alike.

“As you will notice, Johnny Chuck's coat is brownish-yellow, his feet are very dark brown, almost black. His head is dark brown with light gray on his cheeks. Beneath he is reddish-orange, including his throat. His tail is short for a member of the Squirrel family, and although it is bushy, it is not very big. He has a number of whiskers and they are black. Some Woodchucks are quite gray, and occasionally there is one who is almost, or wholly black, just as there are black Gray Squirrels.

“Johnny, here, is not fond of the Green Forest, but loves the Old orchard and the Green Meadows. In some parts of the country there are members of his family who prefer to live just on the edge of the Green Forest. You will notice that Johnny has stout claws. Those are to help him dig, for all the Marmot family are great diggers. What other use do you have for those claws, Johnny?”

“They help me to climb,” replied Johnny promptly.

“Climb!” exclaimed Peter Rabbit. “Who ever heard of a Woodchuck climbing?”

“I can climb if I have to,” retorted Johnny Chuck indignantly. “I've climbed up bushes and low trees lots of times, and if I can get a good run first, I can climb up the straight trunk of a tree with rough bark to the first branches--if they are not too far above ground. You ask Reddy Fox if I can't; he knows.”

“That's quite true, Johnny,” said Old Mother Nature. “You can climb a little, but as a real climber you are not much of a success. You are better as a digger.”

“He certainly is all right as a digger,” exclaimed Peter Rabbit. “My, how he can make the sand fly! Johnny Chuck certainly is right at home when it comes to digging.”

“You ought to be thankful that he is,” said Old Mother Nature, “for the holes he has dug have saved your life more than once. By the way, Peter, since you are so well acquainted with those holes, suppose you tell us what kind of a home Johnny Chuck has.”

Peter was delighted to air his knowledge. “The last one I was in,” said he, “was a long tunnel slanting down for quite a distance and then straightening out. The entrance was quite large with a big heap of sand out in front of it. Down a little way the tunnel grew smaller and then remained the same size all the rest of the way. Way down at the farther end was a nice little bedroom with some grass in it. There were one or two other little rooms, and there were two branch tunnels leading up to the surface of the ground, making side or back doorways. There was no sand around either of these, and they were quite hidden by the long grass hanging over them. I don't understand how Johnny made those doorways without leaving any sand on the doorsteps.”

“Huh!” interrupted Johnny Chuck. “That was easy enough. I pushed all the sand out of the main doorway so that there would be nothing to attract the attention of any one passing near those back doorways. Those back doorways are very handy in time of danger.”

“Do you always have three doorways?” asked Happy Jack.

“No,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Sometimes I have only two and once in a while only one. But that isn't really safe, and I mean always to have at least two.”

“Do you use the same house year after year?” piped up Striped Chipmunk.

Johnny shook his head. “No,” said he. “I dig a new hole each spring. Mrs. Chuck and I like a change of scene. Usually my new home isn't very far from my old one, because I am not fond of traveling. Sometimes, however, if we cannot find a place that just suits us, we go quite a distance.”

“Are your babies born down in that little bedroom in the ground?” asked Jumper the Hare.

“Of course,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Where else would they be born?”

“I didn't know but Mrs. Chuck might make a nest on the ground the way Mrs. Peter and Mrs. Jumper do,” replied Jumper meekly.

“No, siree!” replied Johnny. “Our babies are born in that little underground bedroom, and they stay down in the ground until they are big enough to hunt for food for themselves.”

“How many do you usually have?” inquired Chatterer the Red Squirrel.

“Six or eight,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Mrs. Chuck and I believe in large families.”

“Do you eat nuts like the rest of our family?” inquired Striped Chipmunk.

“No,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Give me green food every time. There is nothing so good as tender sweet clover and young grass, unless it be some of those fine vegetables Farmer Brown grows in his garden.”

Peter Rabbit nodded his head very emphatically as if he quite agreed.

“I suppose you are what is called a vegetarian, then,” said Happy Jack, to which Johnny Chuck replied that he supposed he was. “And I suppose that is why you sleep all winter,” added Happy Jack.

“If I didn't I would starve,” responded Johnny Chuck promptly. “When it gets near time for Jack Frost to arrive, I stuff and stuff and stuff on the last of the good green things until I'm so fat I can hardly waddle. Then I go down to my bedroom, curl up and go to sleep. Cold weather, snow and ice don't worry me a bit.”

“I know,” spoke up Striped Chipmunk. “I sleep most of the winter myself. Of course I have a lot of food stored away down in my house, and once in a while I wake up and eat a little. Do you ever wake up in the winter, Johnny Chuck?”

“No,” replied Johnny. “I sleep right through, thank goodness. Sometimes I wake up very early in the spring before the snow is all gone, earlier than I wish I did. That is where my fat comes in handy. It keeps me warm and keeps me alive until I can find the first green plants. Perhaps you have noticed that early in the spring I am as thin as I was fat in the fall. This is because I have used up the fat, waiting for the first green things to appear.”

“Do you have many enemies?” asked Peter Rabbit, who has so many himself that he is constantly thinking of them.

“Not many, but enough,” growled Johnny Chuck. “Reddy Fox, Old Man Coyote, men and Dogs are the worst. Of course, when I was small I always had to be watching out for Hawks, and of course, like all the rest of us little folks, I am afraid of Shadow the Weasel. Reddy Fox has tried to dig me out more than once, but I can dig faster than he can. If he ever gets me cornered, he'll find that I can fight. A small Dog surprised me once before I could get to my hole and I guess that Dog never will tackle another Woodchuck.”

“Time is up,” interrupted Old Mother Nature. “Johnny Chuck has a big cousin out in the mountains of the Great West named Whistler, and on the prairies of the Great West he has a smaller cousin named Yap Yap. They are quite important members of the Marmot family, and to-morrow I'll tell you about them if you want me to. You need not come tomorrow, Johnny Chuck, unless you want to,” she added.

Johnny Chuck hung his head, for he was a little ashamed that he had been so unwilling to come that morning.

“If you please, Mother Nature,” said he, “I think I'll come. I didn't know I had any close relatives, and I want to know about them.”

So it was agreed that all would be on hand at sun-up the next morning, and then everybody started for home to think over the things they had learned.

> **Stop here.** End of chapter 7. Chapter 8 is optional below; otherwise it opens a later week. Do not jump to AO’s chapter 9 yet.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · OPTIONAL

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 8 · Whistler and Yap Yap

Thornton W. Burgess. Project Gutenberg #2441. Optional second sitting if ch. 7 went well and there is still attention.

CHAPTER VIII WHISTLER AND YAP YAP

Johnny Chuck was the first one on hand the next morning. The fact is, Johnny was quite excited over the discovery that he had some near relatives. He always had supposed that the Woodchucks were a family by themselves. Now that he knew that he had some close relatives, he was filled with quite as much curiosity as ever Peter Rabbit possessed. Just as soon as Old Mother Nature was ready to begin, Johnny Chuck was ready with a question. “If you please,” said he, “who are my nearest relatives?”

“The Marmots of the Far West,” replied Old Mother Nature. “You know, you are a Marmot, and these cousins of yours out there are a great deal like you in a general way. The biggest and handsomest of all is Whistler, who lives in the mountains of the Northwest. The fact is, he is the biggest of all the Marmot family.”

“Is he much bigger than Johnny Chuck?” asked Peter Rabbit.

“Considerably bigger,” replied Old Mother Nature, nodding her head. “Considerably bigger. I should think he would weight twice as much as Johnny.”

Johnny's eyes opened very wide. “My!” he exclaimed, “I should like to see him. Does he look like me?”

“In his shape he does,” said Old Mother Nature, “but he has a very much handsomer coat. His coat is a mixture of dark brown and white hairs which give him a grayish color. The upper part of his head, his feet and nails are black, and so are his ears. A black band runs from behind each ear down to his neck. His chin is pure white and there is white on his nose. Underneath he is a light, rusty color. His fur is thicker and softer than yours, Johnny; this is because he lives where it is colder. His tail is larger, somewhat bushier, and is a blackish-brown.”

“If you please, why is he called Whistler?” asked Johnny Chuck eagerly.

“Because he has a sharp, clear whistle which can be heard a very long distance,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He sits up just as you do. If he sees danger approaching he whistles, as a warning to all his relatives within hearing.”

“I suppose it is foolish to ask if he lives in a hole in the ground as Johnny Chuck does,” spoke up Peter Rabbit.

“He does,” replied Old Mother Nature. “All Marmots live in holes in the ground, but Whistler lives in entirely different country. He lives up on the sides of the mountains, often so high that no trees grow there and the ground is rocky. He digs his hole down in between the rocks.”

“It must be a nice, safe hole,” said Peter. “I guess he doesn't have to worry about being dug out by Reddy fox.”

“You guessed quite right,” laughed Old Mother Nature. “Nevertheless, he has reason to fear being dug out. You see, out where he lives, Grizzly, the big cousin of Buster Bear, also lives, and Grizzly is very fond of a Marmot dinner when he can get one. He is so big and strong and has such great claws that he can pull the rocks apart and dig Whistler out. By the way, I forgot to tell you that Whistler is also called the Gray Marmot and the Hoary Marmot. He lives on grass and other green things and, like Johnny Chuck, gets very fat in the fall and then sleeps all winter. There are one or two other Marmots in the Far West who live farther south than does Whistler, but their habits are much the same as those of Whistler and Johnny Chuck. None of them are social. I mean by that you never find two Marmot homes very close together. In this they differ from Johnny's smaller cousin, Yap Yap the Prairie Dog. Yap Yap wouldn't be happy if he didn't have close neighbors of his own kind. He has one of the most social natures of all my little people.”

“Tell us about him,” begged Happy Jack Squirrel before Johnny Chuck, who is naturally slow, could ask for the same thing.

“Yap Yap is the smallest of the Marmot family,” said Old Mother Nature. “In a way he is about as closely related to the Ground Squirrels as he is to the Marmots. Johnny Chuck has only four claws on each front foot, but Yap Yap has five, just as the Ground Squirrels have. He looks very much like a small Chuck dressed in light yellow-brown. His tail for the most part is the same color as his coat, but the end is black, though there is one member of the family whose tail has a white tip. In each cheek is a small pouch, that is, a small pocket, and this is one of the things that shows how closely related to the Spermophiles he is.

“As I said before, Yap Yap is very social by nature. He lives on the great open plains of the West and Southwest, frequently where it is very dry and rain seldom falls. When you find his home you are sure to find the homes of many more Prairie Dogs very close at hand. Sometimes there are hundreds and hundreds of homes, making a regular town. This is because the Prairie Dogs dearly love the company of their own kind.”

“Does Yap Yap dig the same kind of a hole that I do?” asked Johnny Chuck.

“In a way it is like yours,” replied Old Mother Nature, “but at the same time it is different. In the first place, it goes almost straight down for a long distance. In the second place there is no mound of sand in front of Yap Yap's doorway. Instead of that the doorway is right in the very middle of the mound of sand. One reason for this is that when it does rain out where Yap Yap lives it rains very hard indeed, so that the water stands on the ground for a short time. The ground being flat, a lot of water would run down into Yap Yap's home and make him most uncomfortable if he did not do something to keep it out. So he brings the sand out and piles it all the way around his doorway and presses it down with his nose. In that way he builds up a firm mound which he uses for two purposes; one is to keep the water from running down the hole, and the other is as a sort of watch tower. He sits on the top of his mound to watch for his enemies. His cousins with the white tail digs a hole more like yours.

“Yap Yap loves to visit his neighbors and to have them visit him. They are lively little people and do a great deal of talking among themselves. The instant one of them sees an enemy he gives a signal. Then every Prairie Dog scampers for his own hole and dives in head first. Almost at once he pops his head out again to see what the danger may be.”

“How can he do that without going clear to the bottom to turn around?” demanded Peter.

“I wondered if any of you would think of that question,” chuckled Old Mother Nature. “Just a little way down from the entrance Yap Yap digs a little room at one side of his tunnel. All he has to do is to scramble into that, turn around and then pop his head out. As I said before, his tunnel goes down very deep; then it turns and goes almost equally far underground. Down there he has a nice little bedroom. Sometimes he has more than one.”

“If it is so dry out where he lives, how does he get water to drink?” asked Happy Jack.

“He doesn't have to drink,” replied Old Mother Nature. “Some folks think that he digs down until he finds water way down underneath, but this isn't so. He doesn't have to have water. He gets all the moisture he needs from the green things he eats.”

“I suppose, like the rest of us, he has lots of enemies?” said Peter.

Old Mother Nature nodded. “Of course,” said she. “Old Man Coyote and Reddy Fox are very fond of Prairie Dog. So are members of the Hawk family. Then in some places there is a cousin of Shadow the Weasel called the Black-footed Ferret. He is to be feared most of all because he can follow Yap Yap down into his hole. There is a cousin of Hooty the Owl called the Burrowing Owl because it builds its home in a hole in the ground. You are likely to find many Burrowing Owls living in Prairie Dog villages. Also you are apt to find Buzztail the Rattlesnake there.

“A lot of people believe that Yap Yap, Buzztail and the little Burrowing Owl are the best of friends and often live together in the same hole. This isn't so at all. Buzztail is very fond of young Prairie Dog and so is the Burrowing Owl. Rather than dig a hole for himself the Owl will sometimes take possession of one of Yap Yap's deserted holes. If he should make a mistake and enter a hole in which Yap Yap was at home, the chances are that Yap Yap would kill the

Owl for he knows that the Owl is an enemy. Buzztail the Rattlesnake also makes use of Prairie Dog holes, but it is safe to say that if there are any Prairie Dog babies down there they never live to see what the outside world is like. So Buzztail and the Burrowing Owl are really enemies instead of friends of Yap Yap, the Prairie Dog."

"Why is he called a Dog?" asked Peter.

Old Mother Nature laughed right out. "Goodness knows," said she. "He doesn't look like a Dog and he doesn't act like a Dog, so why people should call him a Dog I don't know, unless it is because of his habit of barking, and even his bark isn't at all like a Dog's--not nearly so much so as the bark of Reddy Fox. Now I guess this will do for to-day. Haven't you little folks had enough of school?"

"No," cried Peter Rabbit and Jumper the Hare and Happy Jack and Chatterer the Red Squirrel and Striped Chipmunk and Johnny Chuck. "We want to know about the rest of the members of the order of Rodents or Gnawers," added Peter. "Of course in a way they are sort of related to us and we want to know about them."

Old Mother Nature laughed good-naturedly. "All right," said she, "come again to-morrow morning and we'll see what more we can learn."

> **Stop here.** Optional only. Do not jump to chapter 9 this week.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Grimm’s Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

Pantheon edition · owned copy · by title only · never reprinted

Open your Pantheon Grimm.

Suggested: *The Elves and the Shoemaker*. Alternates: *Sweet Porridge* or *The Golden Goose* if Elves is already familiar.

Read once. Close the book. Narrate. Avoid a gruesome tale. Never reprint.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

A Child’s History of the World · Real Castles

V. M. Hillyer — owned copy · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Hillyer to “Real Castles.”

Modern editions: about chapter 50. First edition: about chapter 48. Read once (~15–20 min). Close the book. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not reprint Hillyer. Not the same day as Island Story.

READ THIS · FRIDAY

Romeo and Juliet · a gentle sitting

E. Nesbit, Beautiful Stories from Shakespeare. Project Gutenberg eBook #1430. Public domain. Through the secret marriage; stops before Tybalt.

ROMEO AND JULIET · THROUGH THE SECRET MARRIAGE

ROMEO AND JULIET

Once upon a time there lived in Verona two great families named Montagu and Capulet. They were both rich, and I suppose they were as sensible, in most things, as other rich people. But in one thing they were extremely silly. There was an old, old quarrel between the two families, and instead of making it up like reasonable folks, they made a sort of pet of their quarrel, and would not let it die out. So that a Montagu wouldn't speak to a Capulet if he met one in the street--nor a Capulet to a Montagu--or if they did speak, it was to say rude and unpleasant things, which often ended in a fight. And their relations and servants were just as foolish, so that street fights and duels and uncomfortablenesses of that kind were always growing out of the Montagu-and-Capulet quarrel.

Now Lord Capulet, the head of that family, gave a party-- a grand supper and a dance--and he was so hospitable that he said anyone might come to it except (of course) the Montagues. But there was a young Montagu named Romeo, who very much wanted to be there, because Rosaline, the lady he loved, had been asked. This lady had never been at all kind to him, and he had no reason to love her; but the fact was that he wanted to love somebody, and as he hadn't seen the right lady, he was obliged to love the wrong one. So to the Capulet's grand party he came, with his friends Mercutio and Benvolio.

Old Capulet welcomed him and his two friends very kindly--and young Romeo moved about among the crowd of courtly folk dressed in their velvets and satins, the men with jeweled sword hilts and collars, and the ladies with brilliant gems on breast and arms, and stones of price set in their bright girdles. Romeo was in his best too, and though he wore a black mask over his eyes and nose, everyone could see by his mouth and his hair, and the way he held his head, that he was twelve times handsomer than anyone else in the room.

Presently amid the dancers he saw a lady so beautiful and so lovable that from that moment he never again gave one thought to that Rosaline whom he had thought he loved. And he looked at this other fair lady, as she moved in the dance in her white satin and pearls, and all the world seemed vain and worthless to him compared with her. And he was saying this, or something like it, when Tybalt, Lady Capulet's nephew, hearing his voice, knew him to be Romeo. Tybalt, being very angry, went at once to his uncle, and told him how a Montagu had come uninvited to the feast; but old Capulet was too fine a gentleman to be discourteous to any man under his own roof, and he bade Tybalt be quiet. But this young man only waited for a chance to quarrel with Romeo.

In the meantime Romeo made his way to the fair lady, and told her in sweet words that he loved her, and kissed her. Just then her mother sent for her, and then Romeo found out that the lady on whom he had set his heart's hopes was Juliet, the daughter of Lord Capulet, his sworn foe. So he went away, sorrowing indeed, but loving her none the less.

Then Juliet said to her nurse:

“Who is that gentleman that would not dance?”

“His name is Romeo, and a Montagu, the only son of your great enemy,” answered the nurse.

Then Juliet went to her room, and looked out of her window, over the beautiful green-grey garden, where the moon was shining. And Romeo was hidden in that garden among the trees--because he could not bear to go right away without trying to see her again. So she--not knowing him to be there--spoke her secret thought aloud, and told the quiet garden how she loved Romeo.

And Romeo heard and was glad beyond measure. Hidden below, he looked up and saw her fair face in the moonlight, framed in the blossoming creepers that grew round her window, and as he looked and listened, he felt as though he had been carried away in a dream, and set down by some magician in that beautiful and enchanted garden.

“Ah--why are you called Romeo?” said Juliet. “Since I love you, what does it matter what you are called?”

“Call me but love, and I'll be new baptized--henceforth I never will be Romeo,” he cried, stepping into the full white moonlight from the shade of the cypresses and oleanders that had hidden him.

She was frightened at first, but when she saw that it was Romeo himself, and no stranger, she too was glad, and, he standing in the garden below and she leaning from the window, they spoke long together, each one trying to find the sweetest words in the world, to make that pleasant talk that lovers use. And the tale of all they said, and the sweet music their voices made together, is all set down in a golden book, where you children may read it for yourselves some day.

And the time passed so quickly, as it does for folk who love each other and are together, that when the time came to part, it seemed as though they had met but that moment-- and indeed they hardly knew how to part.

“I will send to you to-morrow,” said Juliet.

And so at last, with lingering and longing, they said good-bye.

Juliet went into her room, and a dark curtain bid her bright window. Romeo went away through the still and dewy garden like a man in a dream.

The next morning, very early, Romeo went to Friar Laurence, a priest, and, telling him all the story, begged him to marry him to Juliet without delay. And this, after some talk, the priest consented to do.

So when Juliet sent her old nurse to Romeo that day to know what he purposed to do, the old woman took back a message that all was well, and all things ready for the marriage of Juliet and Romeo on the next morning.

The young lovers were afraid to ask their parents' consent to their marriage, as young people should do, because of this foolish old quarrel between the Capulets and the Montagues.

And Friar Laurence was willing to help the young lovers secretly, because he thought that when they were once married their parents might soon be told, and that the match might put a happy end to the old quarrel.

So the next morning early, Romeo and Juliet were married at Friar Laurence's cell, and parted with tears and kisses. And Romeo promised to come into the garden that evening, and the nurse got ready a rope-ladder to let down from the window, so that Romeo could climb up and talk to his dear wife quietly and alone.

> **Stop here.** Before “But that very day a dreadful thing happened.” The duel and the tomb wait for another sitting.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk or hymn · Ray's (Lesson 20) · Understood Betsy ch. 6 · Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress sitting · Bernstein · nature notebook · evening walk plan

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Plan a longer evening walk if the weather allows.

8:25 **Bible · Luke 20:27–47**

Open your ESV to Luke 20:27–47. Sadducees' question; warning about the scribes. Read once, narrate, stop.

8:40 **Hymn or folk** TRACY JOINS

Whichever needs practice. No Awana on Saturday.

8:50 **Ray's · Lesson 20**

Last Ray's lesson of the week. Oral first. One lesson.

9:10 **Harvey's · short sitting**

~10 minutes from your place. Second sitting of the week.

9:20 **Literature · Understood Betsy ch. 6**

Printed. Cap ~20 min; finish later or at bedtime if long. Narrate.

9:50 **Pilgrim's Progress · Evangelist**

Evangelist finds Christian under the hill (printed, about 1,100 words). Stop at Evangelist's third point.

10:10 **Optional dictation + composer**

Dictation from Bandog line if energy remains. Bernstein *Jeremiah*, five to eight minutes.

How to teach Saturday

> **Luke, Betsy, and Pilgrim’s Progress.** Harvey’s second sitting. Evening walk if you can. Optional Bandog dictation.

Bible

Luke 20:27–47. Open your ESV. The Sadducees ask about the resurrection; Jesus answers; then he warns about the scribes. One reading. Narrate the main thread.

Understood Betsy

Chapter 6 is conversation-heavy (Fisher even jokes about it in the title). Cap twenty minutes; finish later if needed. Ask what farm talk felt new to Betsy.

Pilgrim’s Progress

Evangelist finds Christian under the hill after Worldly Wiseman’s counsel. Christian is ashamed; Evangelist shows him why that advice was deadly and begins the three things to abhor. Stop at the third point. Next week Christian asks whether he may go back to the wicket-gate.

Dictation (optional)

Prepared dictation from *Has anybody seen my Mopser?* — Five minutes. Skip if she’s tired.

Evening

A short walk in Lost Pines or around the yard. Nature notebook: one drawing, date it, scribe one sentence.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she’ll sit, song, maybe Betsy listening. McGuffey during Ray’s and Harvey’s. The shelf books stayed in the same mornings, with no second school day. Week 8 continues the catch-up weave. Seabird still waits for ~Week 19. Trial and Triumph Anselm is around Week 9.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

Bible · Luke 20:27–47

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 20:27–47.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Sadducees' question about the resurrection; warning about the scribes.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

Understood Betsy · Chapter 6

Dorothy Canfield Fisher, Understood Betsy. Project Gutenberg eBook #5347. Public domain. Full chapter. Cap ~20 min; finish later if needed.

CHAPTER VI

IF YOU DON'T LIKE CONVERSATION IN A BOOK SKIP THIS CHAPTER!

Betsy opened the door and was greeted by her kitten, who ran to her, purring and arching her back to be stroked.

"Well," said Aunt Abigail, looking up from the pan of apples in her lap, "I suppose you're starved, aren't you? Get yourself a piece of bread and butter, why don't you? and have one of these apples."

As the little girl sat down by her, munching fast on this provender, she asked: "What desk did you get?"

Elizabeth Ann thought for a moment, cuddling Eleanor up to her face. "I think it is the third from the front in the second row." She wondered why Aunt Abigail cared. "Oh, I guess that's your Uncle Henry's desk. It's the one his father had, too. Are there a couple of H. P.'s carved on it?"

Betsy nodded.

"His father carved the H. P. on the lid, so Henry had to put his inside. I remember the winter he put it there. It was the first season Mother let me wear real hoop skirts. I sat in the first seat on the third row."

Betsy ate her apple more and more slowly, trying to take in what Aunt Abigail had said. Uncle Henry and HIS FATHER—why Moses or Alexander the Great didn't seem any further back in the mists of time to Elizabeth Ann than did Uncle Henry's FATHER! And to think he had been a little boy, right there at that desk! She stopped chewing altogether for a moment and stared into space. Although she was only nine years old, she was feeling a little of the same rapt wonder, the same astonished sense of the reality of the people who have gone before, which make a first visit to the Roman Forum such a thrilling event for grown-ups. That very desk!

After a moment she came to herself, and finding some apple still in her mouth, went on chewing meditatively. "Aunt Abigail," she said, "how long ago was that?"

"Let's see," said the old woman, peeling apples with wonderful rapidity. "I was born in 1844. And I was six when I first went to school. That's sixty-six years ago."

Elizabeth Ann, like all little girls of nine, had very little notion how long sixty-six years might be. "Was George Washington alive then?" she asked.

The wrinkles around Aunt Abigail's eyes deepened mirthfully, but she did not laugh as she answered, "No, that was long after he died, but the schoolhouse was there when he was alive."

"It WAS!" said Betsy, staring, with her teeth set deep in an apple.

"Yes, indeed. It was the first house in the valley built of sawed lumber. You know, when our folks came up here, they had to build all their houses of logs to begin with."

"They DID!" cried Betsy, with her mouth full of apple.

"Why yes, child, what else did you suppose they had to make houses out of? They had to have something to live in, right off. The sawmills came later."

"I didn't know anything about it," said Betsy. "Tell me about it."

“Why you knew, didn’t you—your Aunt Harriet must have told you—about how our folks came up here from Connecticut in 1763, on horseback! Connecticut was an old settled place then, compared to Vermont. There wasn’t anything here but trees and bears and wood-pigeons. I’ve heard ’em say that the wood-pigeons were so thick you could go out after dark and club ’em out of the trees, just like hens roosting in a hen-house. There always was cold pigeon-pie in the pantry, just the way we have doughnuts. And they used bear-grease to grease their boots and their hair, bears were so plenty. It sounds like good eating, don’t it! But of course that was just at first. It got quite settled up before long, and by the time of the Revolution, bears were getting pretty scarce, and soon the wood-pigeons were all gone.”

“And the schoolhouse—that schoolhouse where I went today—was that built THEN?” Elizabeth Ann found it hard to believe.

“Yes, it used to have a great big chimney and fireplace in it. It was built long before stoves were invented, you know.”

“Why, I thought stoves were ALWAYS invented!” cried Elizabeth Ann. This was the most startling and interesting conversation she had ever taken part in.

Aunt Abigail laughed. “Mercy, no, child! Why, _I_ can remember when only folks that were pretty well off had stoves and real poor people still cooked over a hearth fire. I always thought it a pity they tore down the big chimney and fireplace out of the schoolhouse and put in that big, ugly stove. But folks are so daft over new-fangled things. Well, anyhow, they couldn’t take away the sun-dial on the window-sill. You want to be sure to look at that. It’s on the sill of the middle window on the right hand as you face the teacher’s desk.”

“Sun-dial,” repeated Betsy. “What’s that?”

“Why to tell the time by, when—”

“Why didn’t they have a clock?” asked the child.

Aunt Abigail laughed. “Good gracious, there was only one clock in the valley for years and years, and that belonged to the Wardons, the rich people in the village. Everybody had sun-dials cut in their window-sills. There’s one on the window-sill of our pantry this minute. Come on, I’ll show it to you.” She got up heavily with her pan of apples, and trotted briskly, shaking the floor as she went, over to the stove. “But first just watch me put these on to cook so you’ll know how.” She set the pan on the stove, poured some water from the tea-kettle over the apples, and put on a cover. “Now come on into the pantry.”

They entered a sweet-smelling, spicy little room, all white paint, and shelves which were loaded with dishes and boxes and bags and pans of milk and jars of preserves.

“There!” said Aunt Abigail, opening the window. “That’s not so good as the one at school. This only tells when noon is.”

Elizabeth Ann stared stupidly at the deep scratch on the window-sill.

“Don’t you see?” said Aunt Abigail. “When the shadow got to that mark it was noon. And the rest of the time you guessed by how far it was from the mark. Let’s see if I can come anywhere near it now.” She looked at it hard and said: “I guess it’s half-past four.” She glanced back into the kitchen at the clock and said: “Oh pshaw! It’s ten minutes past five! Now my grandmother could have told that within five minutes, just by the place of the shadow. I declare! Sometimes it seems to me that every time a new piece of machinery comes into the door some of our wits fly out at the window! Now I couldn’t any more live without matches than I could fly! And yet they all used to get along all right before they had matches. Makes me feel foolish to think I’m not smart enough to get along, if I WANTED to, without those little snips of pine and brimstone. Here, Betsy, take a cooky. It’s against my principles to let a child leave the pantry without having a cooky. My! it does seem like living again to have a young one around to stuff!”

Betsy took the cooky, but went on with the conversation by exclaiming, “HOW could ANY-body get along without matches? You HAVE to have matches.”

Aunt Abigail didn't answer at first. They were back in the kitchen now. She was looking at the clock again. "See here," she said; "it's time I began getting supper ready. We divide up on the work. Ann gets the dinner and I get the supper. And everybody gets his own breakfast. Which would you rather do, help Ann with the dinner, or me with the supper?"

Elizabeth Ann had not had the slightest idea of helping anybody with any meal, but, confronted unexpectedly with the alternative offered, she made up her mind so quickly that she didn't want to help Cousin Ann, and declared so loudly, "Oh, help YOU with the supper!" that her promptness made her sound quite hearty and willing. "Well, that's fine," said Aunt Abigail. "We'll set the table now. But first you would better look at that apple sauce. I hear it walloping away as though it was boiling too fast. Maybe you'd better push it back where it won't cook so fast. There are the holders, on that hook."

Elizabeth Ann approached the stove with the holder in her hand and horror in her heart. Nobody had ever dreamed of asking her to handle hot things. She looked around dismally at Aunt Abigail, but the old woman was standing with her back turned, doing something at the kitchen table. Very gingerly the little girl took hold of the handle of the saucepan, and very gingerly she shoved it to the back of the stove. And then she stood still a moment to admire herself. She could do that as well as anybody!

"Why," said Aunt Abigail, as if remembering that Betsy had asked her a question. "Any man could strike a spark from his flint and steel that he had for his gun. And he'd keep striking it till it happened to fly out in the right direction, and you'd catch it in some fluff where it would start a smoulder, and you'd blow on it till you got a little flame, and drop tiny bits of shaved-up dry pine in it, and so, little by little, you'd build your fire up."

"But it must have taken forEVER to do that!"

"Oh, you didn't have to do that more than once in ever so long," said Aunt Abigail, briskly. She interrupted her story to say: "Now you put the silver around, while I cream the potatoes. It's in that drawer—a knife, a fork, and two spoons for each place—and the plates and cups are up there behind the glass doors. We're going to have hot cocoa again tonight." And as the little girl, hypnotized by the other's casual, offhand way of issuing instructions, began to fumble with the knives and forks she went on: "Why, you'd start your fire that way, and then you'd never let it go out. Everybody that amounted to anything knew how to bank the hearth fire with ashes at night so it would be sure to last. And the first thing in the morning, you got down on your knees and poked the ashes away very carefully till you got to the hot coals. Then you'd blow with the bellows and drop in pieces of dry pine—don't forget the water-glasses—and you'd blow gently till they flared up and the shavings caught, and there your fire would be kindled again. The napkins are in the second drawer."

Betsy went on setting the table, deep in thought, reconstructing the old life. As she put the napkins around she said, "But SOMETIMES it must have gone out ..."

"Yes," said Aunt Abigail, "sometimes it went out, and then one of the children was sent over to the nearest neighbor to borrow some fire. He'd take a covered iron pan fastened on to a long hickory stick, and go through the woods—everything was woods then—to the next house and wait till they had their fire going and could spare him a pan full of coals; and then—don't forget the salt and pepper—he would leg it home as fast as he could streak it, to get there before the coals went out. Say, Betsy, I think that apple sauce is ready to be sweetened. You do it, will you? I've got my hands in the biscuit dough. The sugar's in the left-hand drawer in the kitchen cabinet."

"Oh, MY!" cried Betsy, dismayed. "_I_ don't know how to cook!"

Aunt Abigail laughed and put back a strand of curly white hair with the back of her floury hand. "You know how to stir sugar into your cup of cocoa, don't you?"

"But how MUCH shall I put in?" asked Elizabeth Ann, clamoring for exact instruction so she wouldn't need to do any thinking for herself.

"Oh, till it tastes right," said Aunt Abigail, carelessly. "Fix it to suit yourself, and I guess the rest of us will like it. Take that big spoon to stir it with."

Elizabeth Ann took off the lid and began stirring in sugar, a teaspoonful at a time, but she soon saw that that made no impression. She poured in a cupful, stirred it vigorously, and tasted it. Better, but not quite enough. She put in a tablespoonful more and tasted it, staring off into space under bended brows as she concentrated her attention on the taste. It was quite a responsibility to prepare the apple sauce for a family. It was ever so good, too. But maybe a LITTLE more sugar. She put in a teaspoonful and decided it was just exactly right!

“Done?” asked Aunt Abigail. “Take it off, then, and pour it out in that big yellow bowl, and put it on the table in front of your place. You’ve made it; you ought to serve it.”

“It isn’t done, is it?” asked Betsy. “That isn’t all you do to make apple sauce!”

“What else could you do?” asked Aunt Abigail.

“Well...!” said Elizabeth Ann, very much surprised. “I didn’t know it was so easy to cook!”

“Easiest thing in the world,” said Aunt Abigail gravely, with the merry wrinkles around her merry old eyes all creased up with silent fun.

When Uncle Henry came in from the barn, with old Shep at his heels, and Cousin Ann came down from upstairs, where her sewing-machine had been humming like a big bee, they were both duly impressed when told that Betsy had set the table and made the apple sauce. They pronounced it very good apple sauce indeed, and each sent his saucer back to the little girl for a second helping. She herself ate three saucerfuls. Her own private opinion was that it was the very best apple sauce ever made.

After supper was over and the dishes washed and wiped, Betsy helping with the putting-away, the four gathered around the big lamp on the table with the red cover. Cousin Ann was making some buttonholes in the shirt-waist she had constructed that afternoon, Aunt Abigail was darning socks, and Uncle Henry was mending a piece of harness. Shep lay on the couch and snored until he got so noisy they couldn’t stand it, and Cousin Ann poked him in the ribs and he woke up snorting and gurgling and looking around very sheepishly. Every time this happened it made Betsy laugh. She held Eleanor, who didn’t snore at all, but made the prettiest little tea-kettle-singing purr deep in her throat, and opened and sheathed her needle-like claws in Betsy’s dress.

“Well, how’d you get on at school?” asked Uncle Henry.

“I’ve got your desk,” said Elizabeth Ann, looking at him curiously, at his gray hair and wrinkled, weather-beaten face, and trying to think what he must have looked like when he was a little boy like Ralph.

“So?” said Uncle Henry. “Well, let me tell you that’s a mighty good desk! Did you notice the deep groove in the top of it?”

Betsy nodded. She had wondered what that was used for.

“Well, that was the lead-pencil desk in the old days. When they couldn’t run down to the store to buy things, because there wasn’t any store to run to, how do you suppose they got their lead-pencils!” Elizabeth Ann shook her head, incapable even of a guess. She had never thought before but that lead-pencils grew in glass show-cases in stores.

“Well, sir,” said Uncle Henry, “I’ll tell you. They took a piece off the lump of lead they made their bullets of, melted it over the fire in the hearth down at the schoolhouse till it would run like water, and poured it in that groove. When it cooled off, there was a long streak of solid lead, about as big as one of our lead-pencils nowadays. They’d break that up in shorter lengths, and there you’d have your lead-pencils, made while you wait. Oh, I tell you in the old days folks knew how to take care of themselves more than now.”

“Why, weren’t there any stores?” asked Elizabeth Ann. She could not imagine living without buying things at stores.

“Where’d they get the things to put in a store in those days?” asked Uncle Henry, argumentatively. “Every single thing had to be lugged clear from Albany or from Connecticut on horseback.”

“Why didn’t they use wagons?” asked Elizabeth Ann.

“You can’t run a wagon unless you’ve got a road to run it on, can you?” asked Uncle Henry. “It was a long, long time before they had any roads. It’s an awful chore to make roads in a new country all woods and hills and swamps and rocks. You were lucky if there was a good path from your house to the next settlement.”

“Now, Henry,” said Aunt Abigail, “do stop going on about old times long enough to let Betsy answer the question you asked her. You haven’t given her a chance to say how she got on at school.”

“Well, I’m AWFULLY mixed up!” said Betsy, complainingly. “I don’t know what I am! I’m second-grade arithmetic and third-grade spelling and seventh-grade reading and I don’t know what in writing or composition. We didn’t have those.”

Nobody seemed to think this very remarkable, or even very interesting. Uncle Henry, indeed, noted it only to say, “Seventh-grade reading!” He turned to Aunt Abigail. “Oh, Mother, don’t you suppose she could read aloud to us evenings?”

Aunt Abigail and Cousin Ann both laid down their sewing to laugh! “Yes, yes, Father, and play checkers with you too, like as not!” They explained to Betsy: “Your Uncle Henry is just daft on being read aloud to when he’s got something to do in the evening, and when he hasn’t he’s as fidgety as a broody hen if he can’t play checkers. Ann hates checkers and I haven’t got the time, often.”

“Oh, I LOVE to play checkers!” said Betsy.

“Well, NOW ...” said Uncle Henry, rising instantly and dropping his half-mended harness on the table. “Let’s have a game.”

“Oh, Father!” said Cousin Ann, in the tone she used for Shep. “How about that piece of breeching! You know that’s not safe. Why don’t you finish that up first?”

Uncle Henry sat down again, looking as Shep did when Cousin Ann told him to get up on the couch, and took up his needle and awl.

“But I could read something aloud,” said Betsy, feeling very sorry for him. “At least I think I could. I never did, except at school.”

“What shall we have, Mother?” asked Uncle Henry eagerly.

“Oh, I don’t know. What have we got in this bookcase?” said Aunt Abigail. “It’s pretty cold to go into the parlor to the other one.” She leaned forward, ran her fat fore-finger over the worn old volumes, and took out a battered, blue-covered book. “Scott?”

“Gosh, yes!” said Uncle Henry, his eyes shining. “The staggit eve!”

At least that was the way it sounded to Betsy, but when she took the book and looked where Aunt Abigail pointed she read it correctly, though in a timid, uncertain voice. She was very proud to think she could please a grown-up so much as she was evidently pleasing Uncle Henry, but the idea of reading aloud for people to hear, not for a teacher to correct, was unheard of.

The Stag at eve had drunk his fill Where danced the moon on Monan’s rill,

she began, and it was as though she had stepped into a boat and was swept off by a strong current. She did not know what all the words meant, and she could not pronounce a good many of the names, but nobody interrupted to correct her, and she read on and on, steadied by the strongly-marked rhythm, drawn forward swiftly from one clanging, sonorous rhyme to another. Uncle Henry nodded his head in time to the rise and fall of her voice and now and then stopped his work to look at her with bright, eager, old eyes. He knew some of the places by heart evidently, for once in a while his voice would join the little girl’s for a couplet or two. They chanted together thus:

A moment listened to the cry That thickened as the chase drew nigh, Then, as the headmost foes appeared, With one brave bound, the copse he cleared.

At the last line Uncle Henry flung his arm out wide, and the child felt as though the deer had made his great leap there, before her eyes.

“I’ve seen ’em jump just like that,” broke in Uncle Henry. “A two-three-hundred-pound stag go up over a four-foot fence just like a piece of thistledown in the wind.”

“Uncle Henry,” asked Elizabeth Ann, “what is a copse?”

“I don’t know,” said Uncle Henry indifferently. “Something in the woods, must be. Underbrush most likely. You can always tell words you don’t know by the sense of the whole thing. Go on.”

And stretching forward, free and far,

The child’s voice took up the chant again. She read faster and faster as it got more exciting. Uncle Henry joined in on

For, jaded now and spent with toil, Embossed with foam and dark with soil, While every gasp with sobs he drew, The laboring stag strained full in view.

The little girl’s heart beat fast. She fled along through the next lines, stumbling desperately over the hard words but seeing the headlong chase through them clearly as through tree-trunks in a forest. Uncle Henry broke in in a triumphant shout:

The wily quarry shunned the shock And TURNED him from the opposing rock; Then dashing down a darksome glen, Soon lost to hound and hunter’s ken, In the deep Trossach’s wildest nook His solitary refuge took.

“Oh MY!” cried Elizabeth Ann, laying down the book. “He got away, didn’t he? I was so afraid he wouldn’t!”

“I can just hear those dogs yelping, can’t you?” said Uncle Henry.

Yelled on the view the opening pack.

“Sometimes you hear ’em that way up on the slope of Hemlock Mountain back of us, when they get to running a deer.”

“What say we have some pop-corn!” suggested Aunt Abigail. “Betsy, don’t you want to pop us some?”

“I never DID,” said the little girl, but in a less doubtful tone than she had ever used with that phrase so familiar to her. A dim notion was growing up in her mind that the fact that she had never done a thing was no proof that she couldn’t.

“I’ll show you,” said Uncle Henry. He reached down a couple of ears from a big yellow cluster hanging on the wall, and he and Betsy shelled them into the popper, popped it full of snowy kernels, buttered it, salted it, and took it back to the table.

It was just as she was eating her first ambrosial mouthful that the door opened and a fur-capped head was thrust in. A man’s voice said: “Evenin’, folks. No, I can’t stay. I was down at the village just now, and thought I’d ask for any mail down our way.” He tossed a newspaper and a letter on the table and was gone.

The letter was addressed to Elizabeth Ann and it was from Aunt Frances. She read it to herself while Uncle Henry read the newspaper. Aunt Frances wrote that she had been perfectly horrified to learn that Cousin Molly had not kept Elizabeth Ann with her, and that she would never forgive her for that cruelty. And when she thought that her darling was at Putney Farm...! Her blood ran cold. It positively did! It was too dreadful. But it couldn’t be helped, for a time anyhow, because Aunt Harriet was really VERY sick. Elizabeth Ann would have to be a dear, brave child and endure it as best she could. And as soon ... oh, as soon as ever she COULD, Aunt Frances would come and take her away from them. “Don’t cry TOO much, darling ... it breaks my heart to think of you there! TRY to be cheerful, dearest! TRY to bear it for the sake of your distracted, loving Aunt Frances.”

Elizabeth Ann looked up from this letter and across the table at Aunt Abigail’s rosy, wrinkled old face, bent over her darning. Uncle Henry laid the paper down, took a big mouthful of pop-corn, and beat time silently with his hand. When he could speak he murmured: An hundred dogs bayed deep and strong, Clattered an hundred steeds along.

Old Shep woke up with a snort and Aunt Abigail fed him a handful of pop-corn. Little Eleanor stirred in her sleep, stretched, yawned, and nestled down into a ball again on the little girl's lap. Betsy could feel in her own body the rhythmic vibration of the kitten's contented purr.

Aunt Abigail looked up: "Finished your letter? I hope Harriet is no worse. What does Frances say?"

Elizabeth Ann blushed a deep red and crushed the letter together in her hand. She felt ashamed and she did not know why. "Aunt Frances says, ... Aunt Frances says, ..." she began, hesitating. "She says Aunt Harriet is still pretty sick." She stopped, drew a long breath, and went on, "And she sends her love to you."

Now Aunt Frances hadn't done anything of the kind, so this was a really whopping fib. But Elizabeth Ann didn't care if it was. It made her feel less ashamed, though she did not know why. She took another mouthful of pop-corn and stroked Eleanor's back. Uncle Henry got up and stretched. "It's time to go to bed, folks," he said. As he wound the clock Betsy heard him murmuring:

But when the sun his beacon red....

> **Stop here.** End of chapter 6. Chapter 7 waits for a later week.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

The Pilgrim’s Progress · Evangelist under the hill

John Bunyan. Project Gutenberg eBook #131. Public domain. Picks up right after Week 6’s stop (Worldly Wiseman’s counsel and the hill).

And now he began to be sorry that he had taken Mr. Worldly Wiseman's counsel. And with that he saw Evangelist coming to meet him; at the sight also of whom he began to blush for shame. So Evangelist drew nearer and nearer; and coming up to him, he looked upon him with a severe and dreadful countenance, and thus began to reason with Christian.

EVAN. What dost thou here, Christian? said he: at which words Christian knew not what to answer; wherefore at present he stood speechless before him. Then said Evangelist further, Art not thou the man that I found crying without the walls of the City of Destruction?

CHR. Yes, dear Sir, I am the man.

EVAN. Did not I direct thee the way to the little wicket-gate?

CHR. Yes, dear Sir, said Christian.

EVAN. How is it, then, that thou art so quickly turned aside? for thou art now out of the way.

CHR. I met with a gentleman so soon as I had got over the Slough of Despond, who persuaded me that I might, in the village before me, find a man that would take off my burden.

EVAN. What was he?

CHR. He looked like a gentleman, and talked much to me, and got me at last to yield; so I came hither; but when I beheld this hill, and how it hangs over the way, I suddenly made a stand lest it should fall on my head.

EVAN. What said that gentleman to you?

CHR. Why, he asked me whither I was going, and I told him.

EVAN. And what said he then?

CHR. He asked me if I had a family? And I told him. But, said I, I am so loaden with the burden that is on my back, that I cannot take pleasure in them as formerly.

EVAN. And what said he then?

CHR. He bid me with speed get rid of my burden; and I told him that it was ease that I sought. And said I, I am therefore going to yonder gate, to receive further direction how I may get to the place of deliverance. So he said that he would shew me a better way, and short, not so attended with difficulties as the way, Sir, that you set me in; which way, said he, will direct you to a gentleman's house that hath skill to take off these burdens, so I believed him, and turned out of that way into this, if haply I might be soon eased of my burden. But when I came to this place, and beheld things as they are, I stopped for fear (as I said) of danger: but I now know not what to do.

EVAN. Then, said Evangelist, stand still a little, that I may show thee the words of God. So he stood trembling. Then said Evangelist, "See that ye refuse not him that speaketh. For if they escaped not who refused him that spake on earth, much more shall not we escape, if we turn away from him that speaketh from heaven." [Heb. 12:25] He said, moreover, "Now the just shall live by faith: but if any man draw back, my soul shall have no pleasure in him." [Heb. 10:38] He also did thus apply them: Thou art the man that art running into this misery; thou hast begun to reject the counsel of the Most High, and to draw back thy foot from the way of peace, even almost to the hazarding of thy perdition.

Then Christian fell down at his feet as dead, crying, "Woe is me, for I am undone!" At the sight of which Evangelist caught him by the right hand, saying, "All manner of sin and blasphemies shall be forgiven unto men." [Matt. 12:31, Mark 3:28] "Be not faithless, but believing." [John 20:27] Then did Christian again a little revive, and stood up trembling, as at first, before Evangelist.

Then Evangelist proceeded, saying, Give more earnest heed to the things that I shall tell thee of. I will now show thee who it was that deluded thee, and who it was also to whom he sent thee. --The man that met thee is one Worldly Wiseman, and rightly is he so called; partly, because he savoureth only the doctrine of this world, [1 John 4:5] (therefore he always goes to the town of Morality to church): and partly because he loveth that doctrine best, for it saveth him best from the cross. [Gal 6:12] And because he is of this carnal temper, therefore he seeketh to pervert my ways, though right. Now there are three things in this man's counsel, that thou must utterly abhor.

1. His turning thee out of the way. 2. His labouring to render the cross odious to thee. And, 3. His setting thy feet in that way that leadeth unto the administration of death.

First, Thou must abhor his turning thee out of the way; and thine own consenting thereunto: because this is to reject the counsel of God for the sake of the counsel of a Worldly Wiseman. The Lord says, "Strive to enter in at the strait gate" [Luke 13:24], the gate to which I sent thee; for "strait is the gate that leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it." [Matt. 7:14] From this little wicket-gate, and from the way thereto, hath this wicked man turned thee, to the bringing of thee almost to destruction; hate, therefore, his turning thee out of the way, and abhor thyself for hearkening to him.

Secondly, Thou must abhor his labouring to render the cross odious unto thee; for thou art to prefer it "before the treasures in Egypt." [Heb. 11:25,26] Besides the King of glory hath told thee, that he that "will save his life shall lose it." [Mark 8:35; John 12:25; Matt. 10:39] And, "He that cometh after me, and hateth not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple." [Luke 14:26] I say, therefore, for man to labour to persuade thee, that that shall be thy death, without which, THE TRUTH hath said, thou canst not have eternal life; this doctrine thou must abhor.

Thirdly, Thou must hate his setting of thy feet in the way that leadeth to the ministration of death. And for this thou must consider to whom he sent thee, and also how unable that person was to deliver thee from thy burden.

> **Stop here.** Evangelist has named the three things to abhor. Next week Christian asks whether he may go back to the wicket-gate.

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